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Breaking Strongholds

Reveal, Renounce, Replace

Purpose

To help disciples identify and break free from lies, strongholds, and agreements with the enemy through Spirit-led deliverance.

Why This Matters

You've spent 8 weeks building trust, learning tools, and experiencing God's faithfulness. Now it's time to go deeper. The Holy Spirit wants to expose what's been holding you back and replace it with His truth.

Preparation (Before the Meeting)

Leaders:

- Pray for Holy Spirit sensitivity and discernment
- Create a safe, private environment (this will get vulnerable)
- Prepare soft instrumental worship music
- Have notebooks/paper ready for disciples to write
- Be ready to provide individual ministry if needed

Disciples:

- Come with an open heart
- Be ready for the Holy Spirit to reveal hidden things
- Trust the process—freedom is coming

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Meeting Structure (90 minutes)

1. Opening & Worship (10 minutes)

- Create a safe, holy atmosphere
- Invite the Holy Spirit to lead
- "Tonight, we're not just learning—we're experiencing freedom."
- Brief prayer: "Holy Spirit, we invite You to lead this time. Reveal what needs to be exposed. Break what needs to be broken. Replace lies with Your truth. We surrender to You."

2. What is a stronghold? (15 minutes)

> *"For though we live in the world, we do not wage war as the world does. The weapons we fight with are not the weapons of the world. On the contrary, they have divine power to demolish strongholds. We demolish arguments and every pretension that sets itself up against the knowledge of God, and we take captive every thought to make it obedient to Christ."* **— 2 Corinthians 10:3-5**

A stronghold is a fortified place—a lie, belief, or pattern that has become entrenched in your mind and heart. It's a place where the enemy has built a fortress in your thinking, and it affects how you see God, yourself, and others.

Examples of strongholds:

- "God doesn't really love me."
- "I'm not enough."
- "I'll always struggle with this sin."
- "I have to perform to be accepted."
- "No one can be trusted."
- Unforgiveness, bitterness, fear, shame, control, pride

Where do strongholds come from?

- Childhood wounds or trauma
- Words spoken over you (by parents, authority figures, peers)
- Repeated sin patterns that become agreements
- Cultural lies or worldly philosophies
- Demonic oppression or deception

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The goal tonight:

We're not going to pick an area for you to work on. The Holy Spirit knows exactly what needs to be addressed. We're going to ask Him to reveal it, and then we'll walk through freedom together.

This is Spirit-led deliverance. We're not the ones doing the work—God is. We're just facilitating an environment where you can hear Him clearly and respond in obedience.

3. Introduce Reveal, Renounce, Replace (10 minutes)

This is a three-step process of Spirit-led deliverance:

STEP 1: REVEAL – Ask God to show you the lie or stronghold

- "God, is there a lie I'm believing about You? About myself? About others?"
- Wait and listen. He will bring something to mind.
- It might be a thought, a memory, a feeling, or a word.
- Don't filter it. Don't dismiss it as "not spiritual enough." Just receive it.

STEP 2: RENOUNCE – Verbally break agreement with the lie

- Acknowledge it needs to go
- Confess it as sin (if applicable) or renounce it as a lie
- Break any covenant, partnership, or agreement you've made with it
- Pray for it to leave in Jesus' name
- Forgive anyone who contributed to this lie (if needed)
- **This must be verbal.** You have to say it out loud. Your voice has authority.

STEP 3: REPLACE – Ask God what He wants to give you instead

- "God, I give You this lie. What do You give me in return?"
- Receive His truth, His identity, His promise
- Declare it out loud
- Write it down so you don't forget it

Critical principle: We are never meant to be empty—we are meant to be FULL of the right things.

If you only renounce the lie but don't replace it with truth, the enemy will try to fill that space again. Jesus said in Matthew 12:43-45 that when an unclean spirit leaves, it looks for a place to return. If it finds the house "empty," it brings seven more spirits with it. **We don't just remove—we REPLACE.**

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4. Guided Reveal, Renounce, Replace Session (35 minutes)

Setup:

- Dim the lights slightly
- Play soft instrumental worship music
- Everyone has space to spread out (not crowded)
- Leaders have notebooks ready to take notes if needed
- This is a time of ministry, not performance

REVEAL (10 minutes)

Leader guides the group:

"Close your eyes. Take a deep breath. Invite the Holy Spirit into this moment.

We're going to ask Him a simple question, and then we're going to wait for Him to answer.

Ask Him this: **'God, is there a lie I'm believing? Is there a stronghold in my life that You want to break tonight?'**

Don't force it. Don't pick something because it sounds good or because you think you should. Just wait. Listen. What's He bringing to your mind?

It might be:

- A belief about God (He's distant, He's disappointed in me, He doesn't care)
- A belief about yourself (I'm worthless, I'm broken, I'm unlovable, I'm a failure)
- A belief about others (No one can be trusted, everyone will leave me, I have to protect myself)
- A memory that surfaced (something someone said to you, something that happened)
- A sin pattern you can't shake (lust, anger, control, pride)
- Unforgiveness toward someone (a parent, a friend, yourself, God)
- A fear that controls you (fear of rejection, fear of failure, fear of intimacy)

Write it down. Be specific. Don't filter it—just receive what He's showing you.

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If multiple things come to mind, ask God: 'Which one do You want to deal with tonight?' He'll show you."

(Give them 10-15 minutes of silence. Leaders pray silently over the room. Play soft music. Watch for people who seem stuck or emotional—be ready to help privately.)

Check-in:
"Has everyone received something? If you're still waiting, that's okay—keep listening. If you've received something, hold onto it. We're going to walk through this together."

(If someone is really stuck, quietly offer to pray with them individually while the group continues.)

RENOUNCE (10 minutes)

Leader guides: "Now we're going to renounce what God revealed. This is where you verbally break agreement with the lie or stronghold.

I'm going to lead you through a prayer, and you're going to pray it out loud—either whisper it or speak it boldly. Insert the specific lie or stronghold God showed you.

Remember: **Your voice has authority.** The enemy must flee when you use the name of Jesus. Let's pray together:"

> ***"God, You've shown me that I've been believing the lie that _____.***
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> ***I confess this as sin. [if applicable] / I renounce this lie as a deception from the enemy. [if it's not sin but false belief]***
>
> ***I break agreement with this lie right now in Jesus' name.***
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> ***I break any covenant I've made with _____.***
>
> ***I break any partnership with the enemy over _____.***
>
> ***I forgive _____ for contributing to this lie. [if applicable—parent, friend, abuser, self, etc.]***
>
> ***I release them from my judgment. I choose forgiveness.***
>
> ***I command this stronghold to leave me NOW in the name of Jesus.***
>
> ***I am covered by the blood of Christ. I belong to God. I am free."***

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Leader after the prayer:

"Take a moment. Breathe. How do you feel? Some of you may feel lighter already. Some of you may feel like you're in a battle right now. Both are normal.

If you need to cry, cry. If you need to sit in silence, do that. We're not rushing this."

(Leaders watch for reactions—tears, relief, resistance. Be ready to pray over individuals if needed. Some may need a hand on their shoulder, some may need space.)

REPLACE (10 minutes)

Leader guides:

"You've renounced the lie. Now don't leave that space empty. This is the most important part.

Ask God: **'What do You want to give me instead? What is the TRUTH?'**

Listen. What is He saying? What truth is He speaking over you?

It might be:

- A Scripture that comes to mind
- A word or phrase ('You are Mine.' 'You are loved.' 'You are free.')
- A picture or image of how He sees you
- A promise He's making to you

Write it down. This is your new identity. Your new reality. This is what you're going to stand on when the lie tries to come back."

(Give them 10 minutes to listen and write. Play soft music. Pray over them.)

Declare the Truth:

Leader:

"Now we're going to declare the truth out loud. One by one, I want you to share:

1. The lie you renounced
2. The truth God is giving you to replace it

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You don't have to share all the details if it's too personal—but declare the truth. Say it out loud. Let the group hear it. Let the enemy hear it. Let YOUR SOUL hear it.

We're going to affirm each other as we go."

(Go around the circle. Each person shares briefly. Leaders affirm and may add a quick prayer of blessing over each person.)

Example:

Disciple: "I renounced the lie that I'm not enough. God says I am fully loved, fully accepted, and fully equipped for everything He's called me to."

Group response: "Amen." / "Yes, Lord." / "We receive that."

Leader (optional): "God, we agree with what You've spoken over [name]. Seal this truth in their heart. Let them walk in this freedom. In Jesus' name."

(Continue around the circle until everyone has shared.)

5. Unpack and Closing Prayer (15 minutes)

Leader prays over the group:

"Father, thank You for what You've done tonight. You've exposed lies, broken strongholds, and replaced them with truth.

We seal this work by the blood of Jesus. We declare that what You've broken tonight stays broken. What You've spoken tonight stays spoken.

We ask You to fill every empty place with Your Spirit. Guard these hearts. Protect this freedom. Let this be permanent transformation, not just a moment.

If the enemy tries to bring that lie back, remind them of tonight. Remind them of Your truth. Give them the strength to renounce it again and again until it has no power.

We worship You for who You are—the Deliverer, the Redeemer, the One who sets captives free.

In Jesus' mighty name, Amen."

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Commission:

"You just experienced deliverance. This is what the Christian life is—continual freedom.

Don't let that lie creep back in. When it tries (and it will), do this:

1. **Recognize it:** 'That's the lie again.'
2. **Renounce it:** 'I already broke agreement with that. It has no power over me.'
3. **Replace it:** 'The truth is _____.'

This isn't a one-time event. It's a lifestyle. You now have a tool you can use anytime the enemy tries to deceive you."

After the Meeting (Leader Follow-Up)

1. Individual Check-Ins

- Text each disciple within 24 hours: "How are you feeling after last night? How's your heart?"
- If someone had a significant breakthrough (deep tears, major revelation), follow up personally with a call or coffee

2. Watch for Spiritual Warfare

- The enemy will try to reclaim ground. Warn disciples in your follow-up text:
  - "If that lie tries to come back this week, don't just ignore it—renounce it again out loud and declare the truth God gave you."

3. Encourage Daily Reinforcement

- "Journal the truth God gave you in your 3D Journal this week."
- "Pray it over yourself during your 4D Prayer sessions."
- "Write the truth on a notecard and put it somewhere you'll see it daily (mirror, car dashboard, phone lock screen)."

4. Celebrate Testimonies

- In your group chat, ask: "How has the truth God spoke over you been changing things this week?"
- Share testimonies of freedom at the start of next week's meeting

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Coaching Tips for Leaders

If someone can't hear anything during REVEAL:

- Don't force it. Quietly pray with them.
- Ask gently: "What's been the hardest struggle for you lately? Let's ask God about that."
- Sometimes people can't hear because they're afraid of what God will say. Reassure them: "God is kind. He's not going to shame you."

If someone breaks down emotionally:

- This is normal and healthy. The Holy Spirit is doing surgery.
- Let them cry. Sit with them. Don't rush them.
- Offer a tissue, a hand on the shoulder (if appropriate), or just silent presence.
- Pray quietly over them: "God, meet them here. Bring healing. Bring freedom."

If someone reveals something that requires deeper ministry (trauma, abuse, suicidal thoughts):

- Don't try to fix it all tonight. This may be bigger than one session.
- Pray "God, we break the power of this over [name] right now. Bring Your peace."
- Afterward, privately offer to connect them with a counselor, pastor, or professional help.
- Follow up within 24 hours.

If the lie is connected to unforgiveness:

- Stop and address forgiveness first before moving to renounce the lie.
- "Do you need to forgive someone? Let's do that now before we break the lie."
- Walk them through a simple forgiveness prayer: "God, I forgive [name] for [what they did]. I release them from my judgment. I choose to let this go."

If someone's "truth" doesn't align with Scripture:

- Gently correct: "I love what you're hearing, but let's make sure it lines up with Scripture. Can we find a verse that confirms that?"
- Point them to God's Word as the ultimate authority on truth.

If the group is hesitant or fearful:

- Leaders go first. Model vulnerability.
- Share your own Reveal, Renounce, Replace moment (either from tonight or a past experience).
- "I'll go first so you can see what this looks like."

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What to Watch For

Good Signs:

- Tears, emotional release (Holy Spirit is moving)
- Breakthrough moments ("I've never seen that before." / "That makes so much sense now.")
- Boldness in declaring truth
- Lightness/freedom after the session ("I feel like a weight lifted.")
- Disciples encouraging each other

Red Flags:

- Complete resistance to the process (may indicate deeper spiritual bondage or unwillingness to surrender)
- Inability to receive truth even after renouncing lie (may need more time, more ministry, or deliverance from demonic influence)
- Shame or condemnation after sharing (address immediately: "There is no condemnation in Christ. You are loved. You are safe here.")
- Someone trying to minimize or joke through the process (may be a defense mechanism—gently call it out)